Basics • Chapter 6

A short history

Last checked 3 November 2026 • 5 minutes to read

Findom is older than the drawn persona, and the written record of it is thin. This page separates what the public record shows, what a few years of experience saw change, and what nobody has dated.

Verified | Reported | Vivian's field notes | Unverified

In 30 seconds

- Findom is older than 2DFD. Papers and press describe it from 2007 onward.
- The written history of 2DFD itself is close to empty. This page says so.
- Payment rails, shop platforms and social accounts have all vanished or changed with little warning.
- Tools arrived in layers and in a release race, with safeguards often coming last.
- Dated proof and personal memory are kept apart here, and each is labelled.

You will learn

- What the public record says about findom, and when.
- Which rails and platforms changed in 2024, and why that matters to you.
- How techdom tools grew, and what a release race does to safety.
- Why no one account, rail or dom should hold everything you have.
- How to tell a dated fact from a memory.

I am a young character in an old scene, and the scene has a short memory. This page gives the dates that can be proved, the changes I saw from inside, and a clear line between the two. Where I cannot date something, I say so.

— Vivian

Before drawn personas

The word findomme comes from femdomme, the word for a female dominant. Verified Findom is older than the drawn persona. A 2021 study cites an earlier paper on findomme culture. Verified A 2016 psychology blog still said that no academic research on findoms existed. Reported Press in 2017 described findom as several years old and as growing on fetish social media sites. Reported

What the public record shows

1

2007

An academic paper by Durkin on the practice appears. Reported A 2021 study cites it. Verified

2

2016

A psychology blog says there is no academic research on findoms. Reported

3

2017

Press calls findom several years old and grown on fetish social media sites. Reported

4

2018

Press covers fake dominatrixes: men who post stolen photos. Reported

5

2020

A magazine feature quotes a sub who kept paying from debt through the pandemic. Reported

6

2021

A second academic paper reports that findom flourished in the pandemic and that literature on it is scarce. Verified

7

2023

Press says the scene is flooded with scammers who use stolen photos. Reported

8

2024

Press quotes a former participant who saw men sell cars, take on debt and take second jobs. Reported

These are publication years. They show when someone wrote about the scene, not when anything began. I found no sourced history of the 2000s, of the first drawn or animated personas, or of who first wrote 2DFD. Unverified

Some doms come to 2DFD from earlier practice with real people, met through chat servers and online forms, and they bring its habits along. One habit is living on a few payers.

The rails keep moving

Two kinds of dependence run through the recent history: the payment rails, and the platforms where a persona is found. Both can change with little warning.

The rails in 2024, unverified

1

2024

A wishlist site used by findommes was reported to have lost its card processor, and no cause is confirmed. Unverified

Some press linked this event to a processor rule change announced weeks earlier. I cannot confirm that link, and no primary source I have read gives a cause. Unverified Platforms also change their pages. A tool that depends on a page's layout or item links can break without warning.

Red flags

Money parked on a rail you do not own

- A dom asks you to keep a balance, credit or prepaid amount with her
- A payment route is said to be closing soon, with a push to spend what is left there
- Your only link to the funds is a login on someone else's service

Counter. Keep your money in your own bank, send only what you planned to give, and treat any balance on someone else's rail as already gone. A dom who sells through one rail should spread her income across routes she can name.

How the tools grew

Techdom tools came in layers, and each layer answered a request from the audience, not a plan. Within a year or two the scene held several product families side by side: web hubs, browser extensions, fake-desktop apps and installable apps.

A wave of apps built to feel like gacha games changed the scene. Money brought in by such apps says nothing about what happened to the people who sent it. See The spiral.

A release race pushes speed ahead of safeguards such as a cap, a wait and a stop. Safe design often means earning less, and in a race that is the first thing cut. The barrier to building keeps dropping, as more doms who do not code learn to build

tools with AI assistants. Cloning is cheap, and a new maker should survey existing tools before spending months on one idea. See Techdom.

People, accounts and quiet servers

Vivian's field notes

A scene career has peaks. Big senders drift away over months, mostly on good terms, and I measure myself against nobody. Servers go quiet, and the talk moves to private messages.

Waves of suspensions for inauthentic behaviour have hit doms and subs on the main social platform, and appeals often go unanswered. An account that is labelled or suppressed is treated as lost, because its posts reach a fraction of the usual audience even when the content is good. Whether a new account counts as evasion of an earlier ban is the platform's decision under its own rules. I do not describe ways around a ban here.

A persona can also change theme over time, and the bio, the hook line and the site then have to be rewritten together. Trend pull is real, and attention moves toward whichever character is newest.

If an account or a rail disappears

1. Keep one page you own, such as a site, that lists where you can be found.
2. Keep copies of your own art and text outside any one platform.
3. If you are a sub, keep no balance or prepaid credit with a dom, and expect that she may vanish.
4. Write down the date and what you sent, in case you need it later.

What is proved and what is memory

What I can tell from the inside covers a short period in one corner of the scene: techdom, chat servers and wishlists. ◑ I say it plainly so that no one takes it for the whole history.

What is on the record and what is memory

	On the record	Memory or unknown
Age of the scene	Papers and press from 2007 onward	The older forum years, with no dated source
First drawn personas	Nothing found	Told by people who were there
The 2024 rail event	Reports without a confirmed cause	The reasons, and who was affected
The tool race	Nothing found	Field notes, from one corner

Myth

Findom began with the pandemic.

Fact

Press in 2017 already called it several years old. Reported Researchers report that it flourished during the pandemic. Verified

Myth

2DFD is too crowded for anyone new.

Fact

Nobody has measured it, and both views are opinions. Unverified

Myth

Subs only chase the newest character.

Fact

This is disputed. Novelty pulls attention, and nobody has measured how much.

Check yourself

Question 1 of 2

Which statement about the history of 2DFD is backed by a source?

- ◯ 2DFD began in a given year, with a given first persona
- ◯ Findom was already described in a paper in 2007
- ◯ A named rail closed for a named reason

Answer. Findom was already described in a paper in 2007. Papers and press describe findom long before drawn personas. The first use of the label 2DFD is not documented.

Question 2 of 2

Your only balance sits on a service you do not control. What is the safest assumption?

- ◯ It can disappear with the service
- ◯ It is insured by the dom
- ◯ It earns interest

Answer. It can disappear with the service. A rail you do not own can close, and the balance can go with it.

Remember it

1 Findom is older than 2DFD. The public record starts in 2007.

2 No source dates the first drawn personas or the label 2DFD.

3 A rail or an account you do not own can disappear with what is on it.

4 A release race puts speed ahead of the cap, the wait and the stop.

5 Keep dated proof and memory apart, and label both.

Check it

Every claim with its evidence level and its sources.

1 The word findomme comes from femdomme, the word for a female dominant.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

2 A 2021 study cites an earlier paper on findomme culture.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

3 A 2016 psychology blog still said that no academic research on findoms existed.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

4 Press in 2017 described findom as several years old and as growing on fetish social media sites.

Reported

Three Financial Dominatrixes on How Their Clients Get Off From Simply Handing Over Cash (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260617102438/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Accessed 3 November 2026

5 An academic paper by Durkin on the practice appears.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

6 A 2021 study cites it.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

7 A psychology blog says there is no academic research on findoms.

Reported

The Psychology of Financial Dominatrixes (blog post) (https://www.psychologytoday.com/us/blog/in-excess/201612/the-psychology-financial-dominatrixes)

Accessed 3 November 2026

8 Press calls findom several years old and grown on fetish social media sites.

Reported

Three Financial Dominatrixes on How Their Clients Get Off From Simply Handing Over Cash (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260617102438/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Accessed 3 November 2026

9 Press covers fake dominatrixes: men who post stolen photos.

Reported

The Curse of the Fake Financial Dominatrix (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260511185644/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/the-curse-of-the-fake-financial-dominatrix)

Accessed 3 November 2026

10 A magazine feature quotes a sub who kept paying from debt through the pandemic.

Reported

How paypigs have been funding their fetish during the pandemic (https://www.dazeddigital.com/life-culture/article/51485/1/how-paypigs-have-been-funding-their-fetish-during-the-pandemic)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260727185610/https://www.dazeddigital.com/life-culture/article/51485/1/how-paypigs-have-been-funding-their-fetish-during-the-pandemic)

Accessed 3 November 2026

11 A second academic paper reports that findom flourished in the pandemic and that literature on it is scarce.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

12 Press says the scene is flooded with scammers who use stolen photos.

Reported

Financial Domination Has a Scamming Problem (https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260827104045/https://www.vice.com/en/article/financial-domination-has-a-scamming-problem/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

13 Press quotes a former participant who saw men sell cars, take on debt and take second jobs.

Reported

[a former participant] has seen men left broke and hungry from 'paying women to talk to them' (https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20251123124217/https://www.sbs.com.au/news/the-feed/article/the-online-kink-thats-leaving-some-men-homeless-bankrupt-and-normalising-suffering/vocm5xt30)

Accessed 3 November 2026

14 I found no sourced history of the 2000s, of the first drawn or animated personas, or of who first wrote 2DFD.

Unverified

15 Some doms come to 2DFD from earlier practice with real people, met through chat servers and online forms, and they bring its habits along.

Vivian's field notes

16 One habit is living on a few payers.

Vivian's field notes

17 Both can change with little warning.

Vivian's field notes

18 A wishlist site used by findommes was reported to have lost its card processor, and no cause is confirmed.

Unverified

19 I cannot confirm that link, and no primary source I have read gives a cause.

Unverified

20 A tool that depends on a page's layout or item links can break without warning.

Vivian's field notes

21 A dom who sells through one rail should spread her income across routes she can name.

Vivian's field notes

22 Techdom tools came in layers, and each layer answered a request from the audience, not a plan.

Vivian's field notes

23 Within a year or two the scene held several product families side by side: web hubs, browser extensions, fake-desktop apps and installable apps.

Vivian's field notes

24 Money brought in by such apps says nothing about what happened to the people who sent it.

Vivian's field notes

25 A release race pushes speed ahead of safeguards such as a cap, a wait and a stop.

Vivian's field notes

26 Safe design often means earning less, and in a race that is the first thing cut.

Vivian's field notes

27 The barrier to building keeps dropping, as more doms who do not code learn to build tools with AI assistants.

Vivian's field notes

28 Cloning is cheap, and a new maker should survey existing tools before spending months on one idea.

Vivian's field notes

29 A scene career has peaks. Big senders drift away over months, mostly on good terms, and I measure myself against nobody. Servers go quiet, and the talk moves to private messages.

Vivian's field notes

30 Waves of suspensions for inauthentic behaviour have hit doms and subs on the main social platform, and appeals often go unanswered.

Vivian's field notes

31 An account that is labelled or suppressed is treated as lost, because its posts reach a fraction of the usual audience even when the content is good.

Vivian's field notes

32 A persona can also change theme over time, and the bio, the hook line and the site then have to be rewritten together.

Vivian's field notes

33 Trend pull is real, and attention moves toward whichever character is newest.

Vivian's field notes

34 What I can tell from the inside covers a short period in one corner of the scene: techdom, chat servers and wishlists.

Vivian's field notes

35 Press in 2017 already called it several years old.

Reported

Three Financial Dominatrixes on How Their Clients Get Off From Simply Handing Over Cash (https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20260617102438/https://melmagazine.com/en-us/story/three-financial-dominatrixes-on-how-their-clients-get-off-from-simply-handing-over-cash)

Accessed 3 November 2026

36 Researchers report that it flourished during the pandemic.

Verified

Findommes, Cybermediated Sex Work, and Rinsing (McCracken and Brooks-Gordon, Sexuality Research and Social Policy 18(4), 837-854, DOI 10.1007/s13178-021-00609-3) (https://www.ebi.ac.uk/europepmc/webservices/rest/PMC8418458/fullTextXML)

Archive (http://web.archive.org/web/20261016030740/https://pmc.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/articles/PMC8418458/)

Accessed 3 November 2026

37 Nobody has measured it, and both views are opinions.

Unverified

38 Novelty pulls attention, and nobody has measured how much.

Vivian's field notes

Nothing here is financial, legal or medical advice for your situation.